

GlobalTrust Financial Services

Remote Work Policy

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1. Purpose

GlobalTrust Financial Services (GTFS) recognises that flexible work arrangements support employee wellbeing, talent retention, and operational continuity. This Remote Work Policy establishes the framework under which eligible employees may perform duties outside GTFS offices while maintaining the standards of excellence, regulatory compliance, and information security required of a multinational financial institution.

Remote work at GTFS is a privilege, not a right. Arrangements must not compromise client service, team collaboration, or adherence to the Information Security Policy (GTFS-SEC-001) and Risk Management Framework (GTFS-RISK-001). This policy supplements the Employee Handbook (GTFS-HR-001) and should be read in conjunction with it.

POLICY NOTE: Hybrid employees may work remotely up to **3 days per week**, subject to manager approval and business requirements. Office attendance is mandatory on core collaboration days.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- **Full-time employees** — primary audience; subject to eligibility criteria.
- **Managers** — responsible for approving requests and monitoring compliance.
- **Contract employees** — where permitted by contract terms.
- **Temporary employees** — case-by-case; typically office-based.
- **Interns** — generally office-based unless programme specifies otherwise.
- **Third-party consultants** — must comply when accessing GTFS systems remotely.

Employees based in Singapore, Dubai, Mumbai, and London are covered. Regional variations may apply where local labour law requires.

3. Eligibility

Not all roles are suitable for remote work. Eligibility is determined by job function, regulatory requirements, and business needs.

Requirement	Details
Probation completion	Minimum 6-month probation successfully completed
Performance rating	Latest rating of 'Meets Expectations' or above
Manager approval	Written approval via HR portal required
Department eligibility	Role classified as remote-eligible by HR and department head
Business requirements	Adequate team coverage and client service maintained

POLICY NOTE: Roles involving cash handling, trading floor operations, or direct client-facing branch services are generally classified as office-based only.

4. Work Arrangements

Arrangement	Description	Approval Level	Max Duration
Fully Remote	100% work from home; no regular office attendance	HR Director + Dept Head	Ongoing
Hybrid	Mix of office and remote; up to 3 days/week	Manager	Ongoing
Office-Based	Standard office attendance; default for most roles	N/A	N/A
Temporary Remote	Short-term remote due to personal circumstances	Line Manager + HRBP	Up to 4 weeks
International Remote	Work outside home country	HR Director + Compliance	Max 30 consecutive days
Emergency Remote	Business continuity or health emergency	Manager (verbal + portal) + HRBP	As directed

International remote work exceeding **30 consecutive days** requires HR Director approval and Compliance sign-off. Tax and immigration implications must be assessed before commencement.

5. Working Hours

Standard office hours (Singapore HQ): Monday–Friday, 8:30 AM – 6:00 PM (SGT). Remote employees must observe the hours of their assigned office location unless otherwise agreed.

Core collaboration hours: All remote and hybrid employees must be available during **10:00 AM – 3:00 PM Singapore Time** for meetings, standups, and ad-hoc collaboration.

Element	Policy
Flexible scheduling	Start/end times may shift ± 1 hour with manager approval
Breaks	60 minutes per 8-hour shift; minimum 30-minute uninterrupted break
Overtime	Prior written approval required for non-exempt roles
Meeting expectations	Camera enabled for video meetings unless manager approves otherwise
Availability	Respond to Teams messages within 30 minutes during core hours

6. Home Office Requirements

Employees approved for remote work must maintain a professional home workspace meeting the following minimum standards:

- **Dedicated workspace** — separate from common living areas where possible.
- **Stable internet** — minimum 50 Mbps download; wired connection recommended.
- **Ergonomic workstation** — adjustable chair and desk at appropriate height.
- **Noise-free environment** — free from excessive background noise during calls.
- **Professional video background** — neutral backdrop; GTFS virtual backgrounds permitted.
- **Confidential workspace** — screen not visible to household members or visitors.

WARNING: GTFS reserves the right to conduct virtual workspace assessments. Failure to maintain adequate standards may result in revocation of remote work privileges.

7. Technology Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Company-issued laptop	GTFS-managed devices only; personal laptops prohibited
VPN	Mandatory for all remote access; idle timeout after 15 minutes
MFA	Mandatory for all remote access per GTFS-SEC-002
Device encryption	Full-disk encryption enabled; no exceptions
Automatic updates	Must not be disabled; patches applied within 72 hours
Email	GTFS corporate email only for business communications
Collaboration	Microsoft Teams for chat, calls, and meetings
Wi-Fi	Secure home network; WPA2/WPA3; no public Wi-Fi without active VPN
Endpoint protection	GTFS EDR agent must remain active
Cloud storage	Approved GTFS platforms only; no personal cloud for work data

Company laptops are replaced on a **4-year cycle**. Remote employees receive priority scheduling for hardware refresh. Refer to the VPN Access Guide (GTFS-SEC-003) for connection procedures.

8. Information Security Responsibilities

Remote employees handle confidential client and company data outside controlled office environments. Strict adherence to the Information Security Policy (GTFS-SEC-001) is mandatory.

- Never use public Wi-Fi without an active VPN connection.
- Lock devices (Windows+L or equivalent) when stepping away, even briefly.
- Report lost or stolen devices to the SOC within **30 minutes** via security@gtfs.com.
- Use passwords of at least **14 characters** per the Password & MFA Policy (GTFS-SEC-002).
- Store confidential documents only on approved encrypted GTFS systems.
- Do not print confidential documents at home without CISO written approval.

SECURITY BEST PRACTICES: Enable screen privacy filters when working in shared spaces. Use GTFS-approved file sharing only. Report phishing attempts immediately. Participate in quarterly security awareness training. Verify caller identity before sharing sensitive information.

9. Performance Expectations

Remote work does not alter performance standards. Managers conduct **monthly reviews** with remote team members to assess productivity, deliverables, and engagement.

Dimension	Expectation
Productivity	Deliverables completed on time; no decline vs. office baseline
Availability	Reachable during core hours; calendar reflects status accurately
Communication	Proactive updates; responsive on Teams and email
Weekly check-ins	Mandatory 1:1 with line manager (minimum 30 minutes)
Performance metrics	Role-specific KPIs tracked in performance system
Deliverables	Documented in quarterly goals; subject to audit

10. Communication Guidelines

- Participate in daily standups at the time designated by your squad.
- Use Microsoft Teams as the primary channel for real-time communication.
- Email: professional tone; respond to internal emails within 4 business hours.
- Maintain an up-to-date calendar showing availability, focus time, and leave.
- Virtual meetings: join on time; camera on unless approved otherwise by manager.
- Meeting recordings require participant consent and must follow data retention rules.

BEST PRACTICE: For client-facing video calls, use GTFS-branded virtual backgrounds and ensure a professional appearance equivalent to in-office standards.

11. Expense Reimbursement

GTFS provides limited reimbursement for home office setup and ongoing connectivity. Claims must be submitted within 30 days with supporting receipts via the Finance portal.

Item	Reimbursement	Approval	Notes
Home internet	SGD 80/month	Automatic (eligible roles)	Proof of service required
Office chair	Up to SGD 500	Manager	Once every 5 years
Monitor	Up to SGD 400	Manager	One external monitor per employee
Keyboard	Up to SGD 120	Manager	Ergonomic models encouraged
Mouse	Up to SGD 80	Manager	Including ergonomic trackball devices
Desk / standing desk	Up to SGD 600	Manager + HR	One-time setup allowance
Printer	Actual cost	Director approval	Rare; digital-first policy applies

12. Health & Wellbeing

Remote work can blur boundaries between professional and personal life. GTFS encourages employees to establish routines, take regular breaks, and disconnect after core hours.

- Access virtual wellness programmes via the HR portal (yoga, mindfulness, fitness classes).
- Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) available 24/7 for confidential counselling.
- Managers should watch for signs of burnout and encourage use of annual leave.
- Report ergonomic concerns to HR for assessment and equipment support.

13. Compliance Requirements

Remote employees remain subject to all regulatory obligations. Working outside the office does not reduce AML, KYC, data privacy, or confidentiality requirements.

- Complete annual AML and KYC refresher training on schedule.
- Handle personal data per GDPR and local privacy laws; no local storage of client PII.
- Do not discuss client matters in public or shared home environments.
- Cross-border data transfers must comply with GTFS data residency policies.

14. Policy Violations

Examples of violations include:

- Using personal laptops or tablets to access GTFS systems.
- Sharing credentials or allowing family members to use GTFS devices.
- Connecting without VPN or disabling endpoint protection.
- Saving customer data locally on personal drives or USB devices.
- Installing unauthorised software or browser extensions.
- Leaving confidential files or unlocked screens unattended.

WARNING: Violations may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, regulatory reporting, and legal action where applicable. Remote work privileges will be revoked immediately for security breaches.

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many days can I work remotely? A: Hybrid employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week with manager approval.

Q: What are core collaboration hours? A: 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM Singapore Time; you must be available for meetings and Teams messages.

Q: Do I need VPN at home? A: Yes. VPN is mandatory for all remote access. Sessions idle-timeout after 15 minutes.

Q: Can I use public Wi-Fi? A: Only when VPN is active. Prefer secure home networks.

Q: What if I lose my laptop? A: Report to security@gtfs.com within 30 minutes. SOC will remotely wipe the device.

Q: Is MFA required? A: Yes. MFA is mandatory for all remote access per GTFS-SEC-002.

Q: What is the internet reimbursement? A: SGD 80 per month for eligible remote roles with proof of service.

Q: Can I buy a monitor and claim it? A: Yes, up to SGD 400 with manager approval and receipt.

Q: How often does my manager review my remote work? A: Monthly reviews are mandatory for all remote employees.

Q: Can I work from another country? A: Up to 30 consecutive days with HR Director and Compliance approval.

Q: Must my camera be on in meetings? A: Yes, unless your manager approves otherwise for specific circumstances.

Q: What is the minimum password length? A: 14 characters per the Password & MFA Policy.

Q: How often are laptops replaced? A: Company laptops are refreshed on a 4-year cycle.

Q: Can I use a personal printer? A: Only with Director approval; GTFS follows a digital-first policy.

Q: How much for an office chair? A: Up to SGD 500 reimbursed once every 5 years.

Q: Who approves fully remote arrangements? A: Department Head and CHRO approval required.

Q: Where is the approval workflow? A: See Appendix C and submit via the HR portal.

Q: Does this policy replace the Employee Handbook? A: No. It supplements GTFS-HR-001.

Q: What if my home internet fails? A: Use mobile hotspot with VPN or attend the nearest GTFS office.

Q: How do I request equipment? A: Submit an IT service request via Appendix D process.

16. Appendices

Appendix A — Remote Work Checklist

- Probation completed (6 months minimum)
- Performance rating 'Meets Expectations' or above
- Manager approval obtained via HR portal
- Home workspace meets Section 6 requirements
- VPN and MFA configured and tested
- Core collaboration hours (10:00 AM – 3:00 PM SGT) confirmed
- Emergency contacts updated in HR system

Appendix B — Home Office Setup Checklist

- Dedicated desk and ergonomic chair
- External monitor (if approved)
- Stable internet (50 Mbps+ recommended)
- Secure Wi-Fi (WPA2/WPA3)
- Privacy screen filter (if shared space)
- Professional video background configured

- GTFS laptop encryption verified
- No confidential documents stored locally

Appendix C — Manager Approval Workflow



Appendix D — Equipment Request Process

Step	Action	Owner	SLA
1	Submit IT service request in portal	Employee	Day 0
2	Manager approves business need	Line Manager	2 business days
3	HR confirms budget allocation	HRBP	3 business days
4	IT procures and ships equipment	IT Operations	5–10 business days
5	Employee confirms receipt and registers asset	Employee	Upon delivery

Appendix E — Emergency Contacts

Service	Contact
Security Operations Centre	security@gtfs.com +65 6123 4500
IT Helpdesk	it-helpdesk@gtfs.com +65 6123 4530
HR Helpdesk	hr-helpdesk@gtfs.com +65 6123 4520
Lost Device Hotline	+65 6123 4599 (24/7)

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